Pemetrexed Monotherapy

To help control non-squamous non-small-cell lung cancer, as maintenance or after earlier treatment.

Non-squamous NSCLC · standalone maintenance or second-line chemotherapy · NCCP 00222 v5 · Document revised 4 November 2026

Your personal plan: this is the standard regimen schedule. Your team confirms your prescribed doses, cycles, treatment changes and appointments in your written plan.

My overall treatment

Pemetrexed alone by drip on Day 1, repeated every 21 days. There is no preset number of cycles: your team reviews benefit and side effects.

Prepare	Every 21 days	Review or finish
Confirm blood tests, folic acid, vitamin B12 and the steroid plan.	One treatment day followed by time at home; repeat only after review.	Agree the next plan. Continue folic acid for 21 days after the final dose.

A typical 21-day cycle

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3–20	Day 21
Infusion day	Day after pemetrexed	Between visits	Review before another cycle

Timing may change after review. Side effects can occur on any day; there are no guaranteed safe days.

My tests and checks

When	What is checked	Timing / reason
Before starting	**Blood count, kidneys and liver** Required by regimen	Before the first dose
During treatment	**Blood count, kidneys and liver** Required by regimen	Before every 21-day cycle
During / after	**Tumour markers, scans or extra tests** If clinically indicated	Scans: team-agreed timing. Markers: only if relevant; no routine schedule.
After treatment	**Recovery and follow-up** Team-agreed plan	Team agrees timing; follow ongoing symptoms or abnormal results

Between treatments

- Day 2: finish prescribed steroid. Continue daily folic acid; B12 is due every three cycles.
- Between visits: watch for infection, mouth or bowel changes and reduced urine. Timing varies; report concerns promptly.

Take folic acid daily and attend for vitamin B12; tell the team if doses were missed. Take your prescribed steroid the day before, on treatment day and the following day. Check with your team before using ibuprofen, aspirin or other medicines, and before any vaccine.

When to get help

Call 112 / 999 for severe breathing difficulty, severe chest pain, collapse or a seizure.

Call oncology immediately: temperature 37.5°C or above, 36°C or below, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell, even with a normal temperature. Follow your hospital's temperature instructions. If you cannot reach the team, seek urgent medical assessment. Do not wait for the next appointment.

Oncology daytime: 087 12345678 · **Out of hours:** 087 87654321

EXAMPLE ONLY — team must replace both numbers before patient use.

Feasibility build. Clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending. Your team confirms your personal plan.

What to watch for

You do not need to know which medicine caused a symptom before calling.

1 Mouth

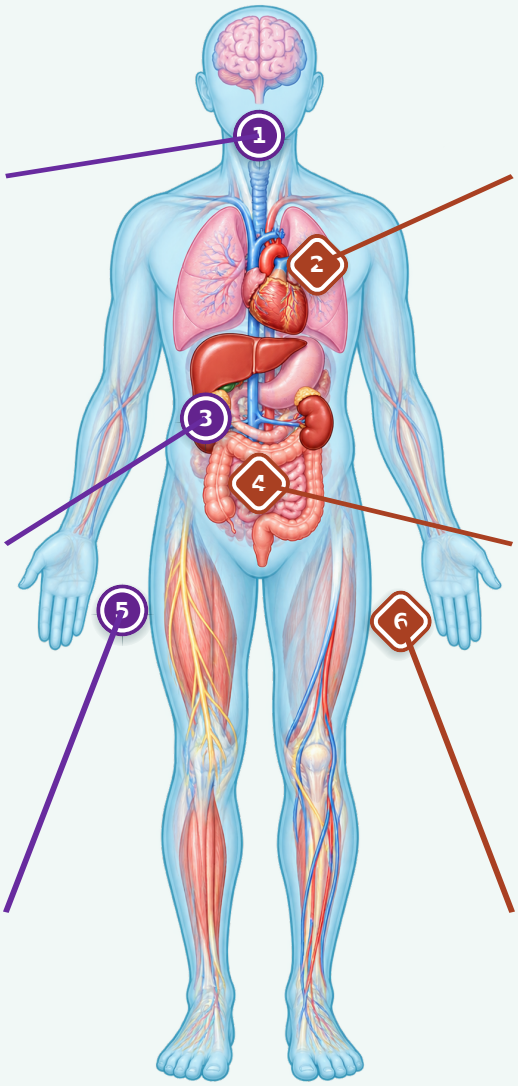
Pemetrexed

Report ulcers, painful swallowing or difficulty drinking.

2 Chest / breathing

Pemetrexed

New breathlessness, wheeze or chest pain needs urgent assessment; lung inflammation or infection can be serious.



3 Kidneys / fluids

Pemetrexed

Report reduced urine, dehydration or inability to drink; kidney tests guide treatment.

4 Stomach / bowel

Pemetrexed

Persistent vomiting or severe diarrhoea needs prompt advice; use prescribed anti-sickness medicines.

5 Hands / feet

Pemetrexed / prior treatment

Report new or worsening numbness, weakness, balance changes or difficulty with daily tasks.

6 Skin / blood counts

Pemetrexed

Report unusual bruising, bleeding or rash; fever or sudden illness needs immediate advice.

Selected effects, not every possible effect or a prediction. Blood-count, skin and line markers are schematic. Number and text carry meaning; colour is decorative.

Call your oncology 24-hour number immediately for a temperature of 37.5°C or above, 36°C or below, shivering or sudden illness. Call urgently for new breathlessness, chest pain, bleeding, severe or persistent diarrhoea, vomiting despite medicines, inability to drink, very little urine or a spreading or blistering rash. Do not wait for the next visit; serious infection can occur without a high temperature.

When to get help

Call 112 / 999 for severe breathing difficulty, severe chest pain, collapse or a seizure.

Call oncology immediately: temperature 37.5°C or above, 36°C or below, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell, even with a normal temperature. Follow your hospital's temperature instructions. If you cannot reach the team, seek urgent medical assessment. Do not wait for the next appointment.

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Keep your treatment details to hand

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Print this page **one-sided on A4 at Actual size / 100%**. Cut only the dashed outer border around both panels. **Do not cut the centre line.** Fold with FRONT and BACK facing out, then glue or tape the blank backs together. Finished size: **85.6 × 54 mm**. Keep the stamp side writable.

FRONT / CONTACTS

My Treatment Card

SACTCheck

Name: _____

Pemetrexed
Day 1 every 21 days; duration reviewed
Phase: _____ Cycle plan: team to confirm
Daytime (EXAMPLE) 087 12345678
Out of hours (EXAMPLE) 087 87654321

Unwell or fever? Call oncology now.
Severe breathing difficulty, chest pain or collapse: **112 / 999.**

EXAMPLE NUMBERS — replace before patient use.

CUT outer border

BACK / TREATMENT RECORD

My cycle record

Rolling record — follow your agreed treatment plan.

Cycle	Date / initials

My treatment information

Latest treatment date: _____

Plan changed? Ask the team to update this card.

FOLD centre — do not cut

Keep the record accurate

The team dates and initials each recorded treatment unit when complete. A cycle is complete after its final planned dose; a weekly-treatment stamp records that weekly dose. Delays, omitted doses or a changed plan need a note or a replacement card. A stamp does not approve the next treatment. Keep any medicine-specific alert card too.

Put your treatment page on your phone

Scan your QR and check the treatment name. Save that page to your home screen.

iPhone / Safari

Tap Share → Add to Home Screen. Select Open as Web App if offered, then Add.

Android / Chrome

Tap the three-dot menu → Add to Home screen or Install and create shortcut. Choose the shortcut option and confirm.

Menu wording varies. The QR opens information, not a personal record. Paper stamps do not update the website. Check that the saved icon opens the correct treatment.

Your local contacts and resources

Oncology daytime: 087 12345678 · **Out of hours:** 087 87654321

EXAMPLE ONLY — team must replace both numbers before patient use.

Hospital / team: _____
Backup if the team cannot be reached: _____

Additional local services and resources will be added when confirmed. Your team must check and complete this page before patient use.

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